

Kindness Means Information for Some Ball Fans

The old mental picture of a crooked gambler turned him into a beady-eyed individual with hat low over the forehead and cigar ashes dribbling down his vest. He was interested in the "fix," the sure thing to bet on. And he was willing to pay.



Roaming Around
by BILL HENGEN

"Baseball hasn't that worry these days," remarked Charlie Wagner, Boston farm system aid. "But there is another possible problem if not checked carefully. It is the man after information."

"A player up to the majors for the first time is bound to be impressionable. And the kindness of 99 per cent of the fans is not misplaced. You know, invitation to dinner, etc. But the player has to be sharp."

"A very, very few try to turn such moves into profit. They want to know clubhouse information about the players. Something not common knowledge which they could turn into the quick buck."

That, according to Wagner, is the modern approach of the gambler. None of this "throw de game" stuff. Just a nice, pleasant, friendly approach of "What do you know that I don't know?"

THE CONVERSATION also swung around to high standards of living for the modern baseball player. The meal allowance per day now is \$10 which, said Andy Cohen, "is a far cry from one of my minor league teams. The players got a dollar-and-a-half and I got \$3 because I was manager."

Added Jack Onslow, the old Chicago White Sox, "yes, and today some of the players try to make too much money off that allowance and hurt their club by not eating properly . . . We used to notice that when the team came off the road those who were getting "weak" by meal-pinching got some of that home cooking and started to play up to form."

INCIDENTALLY, tonight's Baseball Booster list of celebrities recalls some great managers. Cohen was under John McGraw, Enos Slaughter played for Billy Southworth and Casey Stengel, Bill Skowron plays for Stengel and Bob Shaw for Al Lopez.



Miss Pitou Robertson

TED WILLIAMS' baseball future will, of course, be determined by himself. The Boston Red Sox organization expects Ted to come to spring training and then decide whether or not he'll play another year.

BASKETBALL MEMO: Oscar Robertson scored only 13 points against Pittsburgh Saturday night which matched the lowest single-game total in the Cincinnati player's career.

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